

MILO'S GRADED

Pen Independence Training Plan

Multiple 10-minute and 15-minute sessions
from very easy to hard

Designed for Milo, a very young miniature dachshund puppy whose sleeping pen remains downstairs.

The aim is gradual confidence - not forcing silence or waiting through escalating distress.

How to use this guide

Begin at the easiest level that Milo can manage. Repeat successful levels before increasing difficulty. The hardest levels are future goals, not targets that must be reached immediately.

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How This Plan Works

This guide combines both useful pen-training methods:

- Method 1: stay nearby, remain calm and boring, and reward quiet or settled behaviour.
- Method 2: move around, briefly disappear and reappear, and reward calm moments inside the pen.

The sessions gradually shift from mostly Method 1 to more Method 2. A harder session does not mean allowing more distress. It means Milo can cope with slightly more distance, movement or time out of sight while remaining manageable.

Important for Milo's age

Because Milo is only about six weeks old, his confidence, bladder control and ability to self-settle are still developing. Keep the sessions gentle, use many easy repetitions and stop before he becomes overtired.

Before Every Session

- Give Milo a toilet opportunity first.
- Choose a time when he is awake and reasonably calm - not extremely hungry, overexcited or overtired.
- Use part of his normal daily kibble allowance rather than unlimited extra treats.
- Place one safe toy or chew in the pen. Supervise any item that could be chewed apart.
- Keep the room calm. The session should feel ordinary, not like a test.

The Difficulty Ladder

Level	Main skill	Typical distance	Out-of-sight practice
1	Calm near you	Beside the pen	None
2	Small distance	0.5-2 metres	None
3	Room movement	Across the room	None or doorway approach
4	First absences	Mixed	About 1-5 seconds
5	Normal life	Mixed	About 3-15 seconds
6	Flexible independence	Mixed	Future: up to 30-60 seconds

What to Do When Milo Cries

Some brief whining or barking is expected. The important question is whether he can recover, take food and return to calmer behaviour.

What you see	What it probably means	What you should do
Brief whine or one or two barks	Mild protest or frustration	Wait for a tiny pause, reward calmness, and continue with an easier repetition.
Repeated barking but he still eats and pauses	The level may be slightly difficult	Reduce distance or absence by about half. Add one easy minute.
Continuous, sharper crying; frantic scratching; cannot eat	The session is too difficult	Return calmly. Help him settle and end or drop to a much easier level. Do not wait for a perfect long silence.
Sudden crying after previously coping	He may need the toilet, be tired or feel uncomfortable	Check practical needs before assuming it is a training problem.

Rewarding after barking

It is acceptable to reward the first one-second pause after barking. You are reinforcing the quiet pause. The next repetition should be easier so you can reward calmness before barking begins.

Do not turn it into a battle

Never shout, tap the pen, stare him down or deliberately leave him to escalate. The purpose is to build confidence, not to prove that he can be ignored.

When to Move Up a Level

- Repeat a level until Milo completes it successfully at least two times on different attempts.
- Move up when most of the session is quiet or mildly vocal, he still takes food, and he settles again after small challenges.
- Move down when crying grows throughout the session, he cannot eat, or each repetition is harder than the previous one.
- You can mix levels. For example, do Level 3 in the morning and an easier Level 2 later in the day.

Session Menu

Choose one session at a time. The 15-minute sessions increase duration as well as difficulty, so Milo should first be comfortable with the corresponding easier 10-minute work.

Level	10-minute session	15-minute session	Main challenge
1	Safe and Calm Beside the Pen	Extended Calm With You Nearby	Staying calm nearby
2	Small Distance Changes	The Distance Ladder	Distance
3	Moving Around the Room	Movement Plus First Absences	Movement
4	First Disappear-and-Reappear Practice	Short Predictable Absences	First absences
5	Normal Household Activity	Unpredictable Normal-Life Practice	Normal household routine
6	Mixed Short Absences	Future Hard Session: Flexible Short Alone Time	Flexible short alone time

Part 1: Graded 10-Minute Sessions

Use these first. They are short enough for frequent practice and let you identify Milo's current level without overwhelming him.

Suggested use

One or two sessions per day is enough at first. Leave recovery time between sessions and include plenty of normal naps, play and toileting.

Safe and Calm Beside the Pen

Best for: Milo still cries regularly, but can eat and settle when you stay close.

Goal: Teach him that the pen is safe even when you are present but not entertaining him.

Minute	What to do
1	Place Milo in the pen after a toilet break. Sit directly beside the pen, turned slightly sideways. Reward/adjustment: Drop 1 piece of kibble for any quiet pause, sniffing, sitting or looking away from you.
2	Remain beside the pen. Keep your hands to yourself and avoid eye contact. Reward/adjustment: Reward two or three calm moments. Do not reward every second.
3	Shift your chair or body about half a metre away. Reward/adjustment: If he stays quiet for 3-5 seconds, calmly place kibble into the pen.
4	Stay at the half-metre distance. Stand up once, then sit down again. Reward/adjustment: Reward after you sit if he remained calm or became quiet quickly.
5	Walk one step away and immediately return to your seat. Reward/adjustment: Reward a quiet pause after the movement. Make the next repetition smaller if barking increases.
6	Sit quietly and do something neutral, such as looking at a book or your phone. Reward/adjustment: Reward one or two settled behaviours, especially lying down or engaging with his toy.
7	Stand beside your chair for 5 seconds, then sit again. Reward/adjustment: Drop kibble only while he is quiet, even if the quiet pause lasts one second.
8	Take two slow steps away, pause briefly, then return to the chair. Reward/adjustment: Reward the first quiet moment after you return.
9	Return to sitting beside the pen and allow an easy minute. Reward/adjustment: Give one calm reward, then reduce food so he practises settling without constant feeding.
10	Finish with 20-30 seconds of calm beside the pen. Open the pen during a quiet pause. Reward/adjustment: Release him quietly. Avoid an excited greeting that makes leaving the pen the biggest reward.

Success check

Repeat this level if Milo is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Small Distance Changes

Best for: Milo manages Level 1 with brief whining rather than escalating crying.

Goal: Help him cope while you move between beside the pen and a few steps away.

Minute	What to do
1	Start beside the pen for an easy success. Reward/adjustment: Reward the first calm pause.
2	Move one metre away and sit down. Reward/adjustment: Reward after 5-10 seconds of calm. Return to deliver the kibble, then move away again.
3	Alternate between sitting beside the pen and one metre away. Reward/adjustment: Reward calm transitions, not only lying down.
4	Stand up, take three slow steps, and return. Reward/adjustment: Reward a pause in crying. If he remained quiet, wait a little longer before rewarding.
5	Sit one to two metres away for the full minute. Reward/adjustment: Give one or two pieces of kibble during calm behaviour.
6	Walk past the pen once without stopping, then sit down farther away. Reward/adjustment: Reward after you are seated if he is calm.
7	Move closer for an easier repetition, but do not interact through the bars. Reward/adjustment: Reward relaxed body language or quiet engagement with a toy.
8	Move two metres away, stand for 5-10 seconds, then return to your chair. Reward/adjustment: Reward only after a quiet pause.
9	Sit at the easier distance and ignore him politely. Reward/adjustment: Allow him to discover that calmness does not always produce immediate attention.
10	End beside the pen, then release during a quiet moment. Reward/adjustment: Use one final piece of kibble inside the pen before opening it.

Success check

Repeat this level if Milo is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Moving Around the Room

Best for: Milo can cope with you sitting one to two metres away.

Goal: Teach him that ordinary movement does not mean he must follow you.

Minute	What to do
1	Begin seated beside the pen for 30 seconds, then stand. Reward/adjustment: Reward one calm pause before moving.
2	Walk slowly around the room while remaining visible. Reward/adjustment: Approach and drop kibble after 10-15 seconds of calm.
3	Pick up or put down one harmless household item. Reward/adjustment: Reward calmness after the small noise or movement.
4	Sit across the room for 20-30 seconds, then stand again. Reward/adjustment: Reward only once during this minute unless he is finding it difficult.
5	Walk past the pen twice without stopping. Reward/adjustment: After the second pass, reward a quiet pause.
6	Pause near a doorway but remain fully visible. Reward/adjustment: Reward if he watches without escalating.
7	Return nearer for an easier minute and sit quietly. Reward/adjustment: Reward relaxed behaviour, then allow a short food-free period.
8	Walk to the far side of the room, pause for 5 seconds, and return. Reward/adjustment: Reward the first quiet moment after you return.
9	Repeat a mixture of sitting, standing and walking. Reward/adjustment: Use unpredictable rewards so he is not waiting for food after every movement.
10	Finish with an easy seated position. Release calmly. Reward/adjustment: Open the pen after 1-2 seconds of quiet if possible.

Success check

Repeat this level if Milo is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

First Disappear-and-Reappear Practice

Best for: Milo stays manageable while you walk around the room.

Goal: Introduce extremely short moments when you are out of sight.

Minute	What to do
1	Start beside the pen and reward calmness. Reward/adjustment: Give one easy success before any disappearance.
2	Walk around the room while remaining visible. Reward/adjustment: Reward once after a calm stretch.
3	Step partly behind the doorway for 1 second, then reappear. Reward/adjustment: Return calmly and reward a quiet pause. Repeat only two or three times.
4	Remain visible and sit one to two metres away. Reward/adjustment: Use this as a recovery minute. Reward once if calm.
5	Disappear for 1-2 seconds, reappear, then continue walking normally. Reward/adjustment: Reward after quietness; do not rush directly to the pen every time.
6	Do three easy visible movements. Reward/adjustment: Reward the easiest calm repetition.
7	Disappear for 2-3 seconds once or twice. Reward/adjustment: If he barks, wait for a tiny pause when safe, return, reward, and reduce the next absence.
8	Sit nearby without interaction. Reward/adjustment: Allow him to settle without constant food.
9	Mix one 1-second disappearance with visible walking. Reward/adjustment: Reward calmness unpredictably.
10	End with an easy visible minute and release calmly. Reward/adjustment: Finish before he becomes tired or frustrated.

Success check

Repeat this level if Milo is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Normal Household Activity

Best for: Milo handles 1-3 second disappearances with only mild protest.

Goal: Make pen time feel like part of ordinary life rather than a formal exercise.

Minute	What to do
1	Settle him with a safe toy while you sit nearby. Reward/adjustment: Reward one calm start.
2	Walk around and complete a tiny household task. Reward/adjustment: Reward after 15-20 seconds of calm.
3	Disappear for 2-4 seconds, then return without making eye contact. Reward/adjustment: Reward a quiet pause after you are back.
4	Sit across the room and ignore him politely. Reward/adjustment: One calm reward at most.
5	Walk past the pen, touch the door handle, and remain visible. Reward/adjustment: Reward calmness around the departure cue.
6	Disappear for 3-5 seconds once or twice. Reward/adjustment: Reduce to 1-2 seconds if the crying becomes sharper or more continuous.
7	Return to visible movement and an easier distance. Reward/adjustment: Reward recovery and calm engagement with the toy.
8	Carry out another small normal task while visible. Reward/adjustment: Reward after a longer quiet stretch.
9	Mix one short disappearance with two easy visible movements. Reward/adjustment: Reward only one of the three repetitions.
10	Sit calmly near the pen, then release during quietness. Reward/adjustment: End neutrally, without a big reunion.

Success check

Repeat this level if Milo is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Mixed Short Absences

Best for: Milo usually settles quickly after 3-5 second absences.

Goal: Build flexibility with different distances and brief absences without making every repetition harder.

Minute	What to do
1	Start close and easy. Reward/adjustment: Reward the first calm pause.
2	Move around the room while visible. Reward/adjustment: Reward once.
3	Disappear for 3 seconds, then remain visible for the rest of the minute. Reward/adjustment: Reward calmness after returning.
4	Sit one metre away for an easy recovery minute. Reward/adjustment: Minimal food; encourage independent settling.
5	Disappear for 5-8 seconds once. Reward/adjustment: If calm, reward after returning. If he cries continuously, halve the next absence.
6	Complete two easy visible movements. Reward/adjustment: Reward one calm repetition.
7	Disappear for 3 seconds, return, then later disappear for 6-10 seconds. Reward/adjustment: Keep your return calm and ordinary.
8	Stay visible but farther away. Reward/adjustment: Reward a settled posture or quiet play.
9	Mix one easy 1-second absence and one harder 5-10 second absence. Reward/adjustment: Reward only after quietness; do not increase both distance and duration at once.
10	Finish close to the pen and release calmly. Reward/adjustment: End while he is still coping, not after a final difficult test.

Success check

Repeat this level if Milo is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Part 2: Graded 15-Minute Sessions

Use these after Milo is handling the easier 10-minute sessions. The goal is not fifteen minutes of constant challenge; each session deliberately includes recovery minutes.

Important

The higher 15-minute levels are future goals. There is no need to rush through the plan according to a calendar.

Extended Calm With You Nearby

Best for: Milo can complete the easiest 10-minute sessions but is not ready for many disappearances.

Goal: Increase total session length without greatly increasing difficulty.

Minute	What to do
1	Settle Milo after toileting. Sit beside the pen. Reward/adjustment: Reward the first calm pause.
2	Remain beside him without eye contact or conversation. Reward/adjustment: Reward quiet sitting, sniffing or lying down.
3	Move half a metre away. Reward/adjustment: Reward after 5 seconds of calm.
4	Sit quietly and reduce food delivery. Reward/adjustment: One calm reward at most.
5	Stand, take one step away, and sit again. Reward/adjustment: Reward a quiet pause.
6	Move one metre away for 20-30 seconds. Reward/adjustment: Return to deliver kibble, then move away again.
7	Come closer for an easy recovery minute. Reward/adjustment: Reward settled behaviour.
8	Stand beside the pen without interacting. Reward/adjustment: Reward if he remains calm while you are upright.
9	Walk two slow steps away and return. Reward/adjustment: Reward after calmness.
10	Sit one metre away and look occupied. Reward/adjustment: Allow a food-free stretch.
11	Walk once around the room while visible. Reward/adjustment: Reward when you return to your chair.
12	Remain close for a recovery minute. Reward/adjustment: One small reward for calmness.
13	Move one metre away again. Reward/adjustment: Reward after a slightly longer quiet period.
14	Sit beside the pen but continue ignoring politely. Reward/adjustment: Do not make the ending obvious or exciting.
15	Give one final calm reward and release during quietness. Reward/adjustment: End neutrally.

Success check

Repeat this level if Milo is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

The Distance Ladder

Best for: Milo can stay calm with you nearby for 15 minutes.

Goal: Practise several distances while keeping you visible.

Minute	What to do
1	Start beside the pen. Reward/adjustment: Reward a calm start.
2	Move half a metre away. Reward/adjustment: Reward once.
3	Move one metre away. Reward/adjustment: Reward after 5-10 seconds of quiet.
4	Return closer for an easy minute. Reward/adjustment: Reward recovery.
5	Move two metres away and sit. Reward/adjustment: Reward once during calmness.
6	Stand at the same distance, then sit again. Reward/adjustment: Reward calm response to the change.
7	Walk across the room and return to the two-metre position. Reward/adjustment: Reward after you are seated.
8	Move beside the pen for recovery without interacting. Reward/adjustment: Minimal food.
9	Move to the far side of the room for 10-20 seconds. Reward/adjustment: Reward if manageable.
10	Walk past the pen without stopping. Reward/adjustment: Reward later, not immediately every time.
11	Sit two metres away and remain boring. Reward/adjustment: Allow a food-free settling period.
12	Move closer, then farther again. Reward/adjustment: Reward a calm transition.
13	Walk a small circle around the room. Reward/adjustment: Reward after a quiet pause.
14	Return to an easy distance. Reward/adjustment: One final calm reward.
15	Release quietly during a calm moment. Reward/adjustment: Avoid an excited greeting.

Success check

Repeat this level if Milo is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Movement Plus First Absences

Best for: Milo manages visible distance changes and some 1-3 second disappearances.

Goal: Blend normal movement with very brief out-of-sight repetitions.

Minute	What to do
1	Start beside the pen. Reward/adjustment: Reward calmness.
2	Walk slowly around the room. Reward/adjustment: Reward once.
3	Step out of sight for 1 second twice. Reward/adjustment: Reward a quiet pause after returning.
4	Sit one metre away for recovery. Reward/adjustment: One reward at most.
5	Complete a small visible household action. Reward/adjustment: Reward calmness after the movement.
6	Disappear for 2 seconds once or twice. Reward/adjustment: Reduce difficulty if barking escalates.
7	Remain visible and sit across the room. Reward/adjustment: Allow a food-free stretch.
8	Walk past the doorway but do not disappear. Reward/adjustment: Reward calm response to the cue.
9	Disappear for 2-3 seconds once. Reward/adjustment: Reward quietness after returning.
10	Come nearer for recovery without touching him. Reward/adjustment: Reward settled behaviour.
11	Walk around normally while visible. Reward/adjustment: One unpredictable reward.
12	Disappear for 1 second, then later for 3 seconds. Reward/adjustment: Keep both returns calm.
13	Sit one to two metres away. Reward/adjustment: Allow him to settle.
14	Finish with visible, easy movement. Reward/adjustment: Reward one calm moment.
15	Release quietly. Reward/adjustment: End before overtired crying begins.

Success check

Repeat this level if Milo is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Short Predictable Absences

Best for: Milo can recover quickly after 2-3 second disappearances.

Goal: Build absences of approximately 3-10 seconds while mixing in many easy repetitions.

Minute	What to do
1	Start close and easy. Reward/adjustment: Reward one calm pause.
2	Move around while visible. Reward/adjustment: Reward once.
3	Disappear for 3 seconds once. Reward/adjustment: Reward a quiet pause after returning.
4	Sit nearby for recovery. Reward/adjustment: Minimal food.
5	Disappear for 4-5 seconds once. Reward/adjustment: If he copes, reward calmly.
6	Complete two visible movements. Reward/adjustment: Reward one of them.
7	Disappear for 3 seconds, return, and remain visible. Reward/adjustment: Reward after calmness.
8	Sit farther away for a quiet minute. Reward/adjustment: Allow independent settling.
9	Disappear for 5-7 seconds once. Reward/adjustment: Halve the next absence if crying becomes continuous.
10	Come closer for recovery. Reward/adjustment: Reward calmness, not excitement.
11	Walk past the pen and touch the door handle. Reward/adjustment: Reward calm response to the cue.
12	Disappear for 3 seconds, then later for 6-8 seconds. Reward/adjustment: Keep the second repetition optional if he is tired.
13	Remain visible and boring. Reward/adjustment: No reward unless needed.
14	Finish with an easy visible minute. Reward/adjustment: One final calm reward.
15	Release during a quiet pause. Reward/adjustment: End neutrally.

Success check

Repeat this level if Milo is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Unpredictable Normal-Life Practice

Best for: Milo manages 5-10 second absences without escalating.

Goal: Prevent him from predicting exactly when you leave, return or reward.

Minute	What to do
1	Start beside the pen and then move away. Reward/adjustment: Reward one calm start.
2	Perform a normal visible task. Reward/adjustment: Reward after a longer calm stretch.
3	Disappear for 5 seconds once. Reward/adjustment: Return calmly; reward quietness.
4	Sit across the room. Reward/adjustment: No reward unless he settles particularly well.
5	Walk past the pen twice without stopping. Reward/adjustment: Reward later, not immediately.
6	Disappear for 8-12 seconds once. Reward/adjustment: Reduce to 3-5 seconds if needed.
7	Return and continue the task rather than going directly to him. Reward/adjustment: Reward after he is quiet.
8	Sit nearby for recovery. Reward/adjustment: One small reward.
9	Disappear for 3 seconds, then remain visible. Reward/adjustment: Easy repetition.
10	Complete a quiet household task for the full minute. Reward/adjustment: Reward at the end if calm.
11	Disappear for 10-15 seconds once. Reward/adjustment: Only attempt if the previous minutes were manageable.
12	Return and sit one to two metres away. Reward/adjustment: Allow him to settle without immediate food.
13	Mix visible walking with one 5-second absence. Reward/adjustment: Reward unpredictably.
14	Finish close and calm. Reward/adjustment: One final reward inside the pen.
15	Release quietly during calmness. Reward/adjustment: No big reunion.

Success check

Repeat this level if Milo is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Future Hard Session: Flexible Short Alone Time

Best for: Use only after Milo repeatedly succeeds at Level 5. This may be a future level rather than a current one.

Goal: Build flexible absences up to about 30-60 seconds, with easy repetitions between them.

Minute	What to do
1	Begin close and easy. Reward/adjustment: Reward calmness.
2	Walk around while visible. Reward/adjustment: Reward once.
3	Disappear for 8-10 seconds. Reward/adjustment: Reward a quiet pause after returning.
4	Sit nearby for recovery. Reward/adjustment: Minimal food.
5	Disappear for 15-20 seconds once. Reward/adjustment: Return earlier if distress escalates.
6	Stay visible and perform an easy task. Reward/adjustment: Reward recovery.
7	Disappear for 5 seconds only. Reward/adjustment: This easier repetition prevents constant escalation.
8	Sit across the room for the full minute. Reward/adjustment: Allow independent settling.
9	Disappear for 20-30 seconds once. Reward/adjustment: Attempt only if he is calm and still taking food.
10	Return and remain visible. Reward/adjustment: Reward after quietness.
11	Complete two easy visible movements. Reward/adjustment: Reward one calm response.
12	Optional: disappear for 30-45 seconds. Otherwise repeat 10 seconds. Reward/adjustment: Choose the easier option whenever unsure.
13	Return and sit near the pen for recovery. Reward/adjustment: Give one calm reward.
14	Keep the final minute easy and visible. Reward/adjustment: Do not add a last difficult test.
15	Release quietly during calmness. Reward/adjustment: End while he is coping.

Success check

Repeat this level if Milo is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Example Progression

This is only an example. Progress according to Milo's behaviour, not according to fixed dates.

Stage	Possible choice	What decides the next step
Starting point	10-minute Level 1 or 2	Choose the easiest level where he can still eat and pause.
Building movement	10-minute Level 3	Repeat until walking around the room is ordinary.
First disappearances	10-minute Level 4	Keep absences tiny and return before escalation whenever possible.
Increasing duration	15-minute Level 1-3	Increase total time while keeping the challenge moderate.
Normal household life	10-minute Level 5-6 or 15-minute Level 4-5	Mix easy and hard repetitions rather than increasing every minute.
Future independence	15-minute Level 6	Use only once shorter absences are consistently manageable.
A good session is not a silent session A good session is one where Milo remains safe, can recover from small protests, and finishes at the same or lower stress level than he started.		

Progress Tracker

Use one row after each session. This makes it easier to notice progress that may be missed from day to day.

Date	10/15	Level	Calm score	Longest absence	Repeat/move	Notes

Calm Score Guide

0	Relaxed, playing, sniffing or lying down; little or no crying.
1	Alert with brief whining, but settles easily and takes food.
2	Repeated barking or whining, but still pauses and can recover.
3	Escalating or continuous distress, frantic behaviour or refusal of food.

Final Reminders

- Milo does not need to complete every level quickly. Confidence is built through repetition.
- Increase only one main difficulty at a time: distance, movement, time out of sight or total session length.
- Always include easier minutes after a difficult repetition.
- A one-second quiet pause is enough to reward at the beginning.
- Check toileting, tiredness, hunger, temperature and comfort when his behaviour suddenly worsens.
- The pen should also be used for pleasant everyday experiences, including meals, toys and naps - not only independence exercises.
- Because Milo is exceptionally young, seek guidance from a veterinarian or qualified force-free trainer if crying becomes intense, he cannot settle at all, or his behaviour changes suddenly.

The overall rule

Make the next repetition easy enough that Milo has a realistic chance to succeed. Calm confidence grows faster from many manageable repetitions than from one session that is too hard.

End of plan